

Mobile Watch

All the latest buzz from the world of smartphones and tablets, head on over here for your monthly mobile fix

App Watch

We do a round-up of some of the best app tracking apps that you need to install on your smart device

Controlling Interest

The future of uncontrolled access to content and information in India seems bleak. With new stringent measures being put into place, it could only get more draconian in time. Welcome to a more prevalent Big Brother!

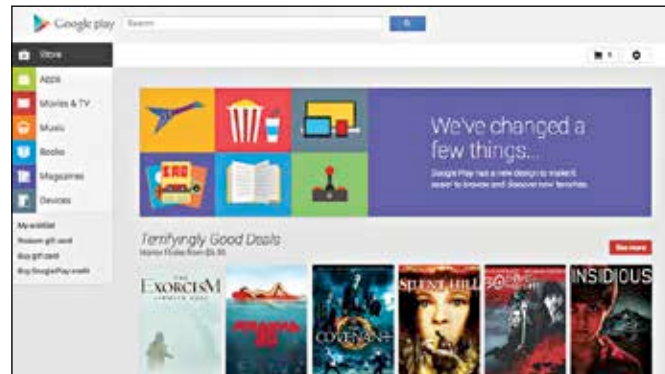
SC asks Govt. to develop solution to block porn sites

The Supreme Court has advised the Indian Government to work with various ministries – including Information and Technology, Information and Broadcasting and Home Affairs – to come up with a solution to take down pornographic content from the web. The government had told the apex court that it would be difficult to block international porn websites in India.

Earlier this year, the Indian Government had ordered the Internet Service Providers (ISPs) to take down as many as 39 websites for hosting obscene content. The order came in the wake of a petition filed by a Indore-based advocate Kamlesh Vaswani, according to whom watching obscene videos is not an offence but is among major reasons behind crime against women.

According to a Times of India report, most of the sites blocked are web forums where users share images and links to download porn content. Some of these sites are also used to host and share images and files. The report further illustrates the fact that the blocked sites are hosted outside India and supposedly operate under the US' 18 USC 2257 law.

The petition further highlights the lack of adequate Internet laws that encourages people to access obscene videos. More than 20 crore such videos/clippings are available



The redesigned Google Play Store highlights movies and books

in the market and are being downloaded through web or accessed via video CDs, said the petitioner through counsel Virag Gupta.

Yahoo acquires Qwiki and Xobni

Yahoo CEO Marissa Mayer has continued with her buying spree of internet start-ups and has bought over Qwiki and Xobni, a video-sharing app and contact management company, respectively. Qwiki was acquired for \$50 million to compete with Twitter's Vine. Qwiki is a cool video-sharing app that changes pictures and videos from the user's camera roll into small movies that can be shared by the user.

Post-announcement of the acquisition, Yahoo asked in a recent blog post, "Have you ever listened to an old song and all of a sudden a favorite vacation, concert, or summer memory pops into your mind? The Qwiki app automatically turns pictures and videos that you already have on your iPhone

into quick, beautiful movies to share, including transitions and a soundtrack."

Yahoo bought Xobni for just over \$48 million to improve Yahoo! Mail and other related applications. However, the buyout has resulted in some of Xobni's products being shut down. The contact management company has released a FAQ stating that it plans to continue supporting its contact management tools for Outlook, but support for other platforms may expire on 2nd July, 2014.

"Not to worry — we aren't pulling the rug out from under you. If you're using a Xobni product today, you can keep using it," the Xobni team said in a blog post. The company stated that Xobni for BlackBerry and Smartr Contacts for Android are also no longer available for download officially. It also pulled out the Android app. Further, Xobni won't be accepting any more premium subscriptions such as Xobni Pro, Xobni for Teams, the Xobni JIRA Gadget, etc.

Google redesigns Play Store, Maps web interface

Google has extended the smartphone and tablet Play Store interface to web browsers as well, accessible from any desktop. The idea is clearly to let the customer know that there's a variety of content on offer and to make it easier to find that content.

Google made this announcement with a simple post on Google+, accompanied by an image of the redesigned store front. "The redesigned Google Play Store on #Android devices is now on the web: goo.gl/DPIDq. Play like never before with our fresh new look."

The change is for the better, because it highlights the non-app content – Movies and Books



– in a way that the previous design couldn't. The homepage is a lot cleaner, with bigger images and text lending to its appeal. Yes, it does mean that the page becomes longer, but the focus is now primarily on content, with no distractions. Books and movies now get a bigger mention on the first page itself, accompanied by big posters, to draw your attention.

The main navigation menu, listing the categories, now sits vertically on the left corner, not taking up too much space. At the moment, there's a banner at the top informing visitors